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Motherboards Test

Contact sheet

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ECS	Rashi Peripherals Pvt Ltd	91 22 4047 0828	response@rptechindia.com	www.reptechindia.com
Gigabyte	GIGABYTE Technology India Pvt. Ltd.	91-22-40633218	anilkumarr@gigabyte.in	www.gigabyte.in
Intel	Intel	080-28542105	sasupport@mailbox.intel.com	www.intel.com
MSI	MSI India	1800 200000 4	marketingindia@msi.com	http://in.msi.com
Zotac	Neoteric Informatique Ltd.	+91-9891282522	tarun.kalra@neoteric.co.in	www.zotac.com

nectors bundled along with the board. It only supports CrossFire at x8/x8 configuration. The BIOS menu of the MSI board is quite attractive to look at. If you leave aside the proprietary RoG features, this board is comparable to the Maximus IV Gene Z. There are more display ports (DVI and VGA) on the MSI board. Pricing wise the ASUS board is ₹400 cheaper, so it's anyone's guess which is a better option.

If you plan to use graphics cards on all the slots then you'll lose access to USB headers and power/reset buttons in the MSI Z68MA ED55 board and in the ASUS P8Z68-V board as a dual slot card will cover these ports.

Winner: ASUS Maximus IV Gene Z was awarded the Best Buy for the simple reason that you're getting all the goodness of a high end gaming board in a micro ATX form factor. The pricing may seem high for a micro ATX board, but if you do plan to pursue gaming or overclocking, there is no better choice in this range. For normal users, the ASUS P8Z68V-LE makes sense.

Under ₹10,000

We got just four sub ₹10,000 boards here, including the Biostar TZ68K+, Gigabyte Z68AP D3, ASRock Z68 Extreme3 Gen3 and ASUS P8Z68-M Pro, which shows that Z68 boards aren't cheap.

can't add more USB 3.0 ports, which is just sad. The UEFI BIOS of Biostar board is quite easy to operate although it's not as good looking as the one found on ASUS or MSI boards. A very interesting addition to the Biostar board is the BIO-



ASRock Z68 Extreme3 Gen3

Biostar TZ68K+ makes for a good entry-level Z68 motherboard but the surprisingly limited connectivity options on the back panel I/O will leave many of you disappointed. There are only two USB ports on the back panel and the absence of a USB 3.0 header means that you

Remote 2, which is basically an Android and iPhone application that lets you control your PC with your cellphone. You can use your phone as a remote control, as a mouse, to overclock your system or update the BIOS of your system remotely. Quite impressive at sub-₹10,000.

ASUS P8Z68-M Pro is a compact board with as many as five USB 2.0 headers, five SATA ports and features such as iGPU Boost (which over-clocks the integrated GPU with an on-board switch) and MemOK button. Although there are two PCIe x16 slots, only one of them is true x16 whereas the other is locked to run at x4. The heatsink quality is strictly OK as compared to ones seen on higher end boards, but it's much better than the Biostar one.

Gigabyte Z68AP D3 includes a unique feature in the form of an mSATA connector on which you can lodge a solid state drive. Another aspect that stands out on this board is the presence of serial and parallel ports on the back panel IO. Now these ports are rarely used in a home environment, so it makes us wonder if Gigabyte is targeting this board at SOHO set-ups. But the presence of an HDMI port is reassuring. The mSATA connector allows you to populate the board with your choice of SSD. Setting up the Rapid Storage Transport technology using Gigabyte's EZ Smart Response utility is a breeze. Don't expect extreme levels of overclocking on this board though.

The build quality of the Gigabyte and ASUS boards is better than the Biostar boards.

ASRock Z68 Extreme3 Gen3 has good styling, which reminds you of its elder brother



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